GLOBAL MENTORSHIP INITIATIVE

# Session 6
# GMI - Use the STAR Interview Technique to Land a Job

During the interview mentorship sessions with your mentor, you will sharpen your interview skills. We recommend using the STAR method to answer complex interview questions because it will distinguish you from other job applicants.

**S - SITUATION** Briefly explain the situation.

**T - TASK** Your role in the situation and level of responsibility.

**A - ACTION** What action did you take to overcome the challenges?

**R - RESULT** How was the situation resolved?

For a more detailed explanation, here is an excerpt from an article by Ruth Mayhew, HR Consultant:

Behavioral interview questions generally are based on the premise that past performance and behavior are clear indicators of future performance. Recruiters and hiring managers consider your work history, skills, and education among your qualifications.

However, they're also keen on learning whether you're capable of handling certain responsibilities and challenges, which is why a proven interview-response technique is likely to position you as a suitably qualified candidate.

**Behavioral Interview Questions**
"Tell me about a time when ..." is how many behavioral interview questions start. Your answer should describe how you approached your previous job duties, responsibilities, challenges, and interpersonal relationships in the workplace.

Behavioral interview questions differ from, say, situational interview questions, which typically quiz a job candidate about a process or procedure related to functional expertise. An example of a situational interview question is, "How do you migrate data from one server to another?"

**Model Response**
Using the STAR technique will almost guarantee that you're providing a complete answer to the interviewer's question, provided you use understandable examples from past work experience.

For example, the interviewer might ask, "Tell me about a time when you had to collaborate with another department on a project." Your response, based on the STAR technique could be, "Last year, our sales department discovered that residential customers were dissatisfied with the delivery time of items they purchased on the weekends. I was the salesperson designated to work with the shipping department on reducing delivery times. The first order of business was to streamline communication between sales orders and the shipping department. We asked IT to enable 24-hour capability for marking online purchases for shipment, instead of waiting until the next business day. Finally, we asked customers

placing orders to provide us with feedback through a new web survey. The result was that we saw customer satisfaction with shipping delivery increase to 98 percent and, on average, we shaved 1.5 days off the regular shipment time."

**Benefits**

STAR interview responses are relatively easy to construct and rehearse. They're practically formulaic, and once you get the hang of using the formula, giving good answers to interviewers' questions comes naturally.

Another advantage is that most interviewers recognize the STAR technique for responding to questions. And, regardless of whether your answers are what the interviewer was actually seeking, consistent use of this technique throughout your interview illustrates your level of effort and enthusiasm.

Effort and enthusiasm are evidence that you take the process seriously and that you're concerned about making a favorable impression on the interviewer.

More information about STAR: https://www.indeed.com/hire/c/info/star-interview-format